



AI needs sleep too

AI designed to function like a human could also benefit from "sleep" the way biological brains do. <http://digit.in/sep20-23>



747 gets floppy disk updates

The 20 year old Boeing 747 still gets critical software updates via 3.5-inch floppy disks. <http://digit.in/sep20-24>

Sony HT-G700

Sublime Sound

The Sony HT-G700 is a 3.1 soundbar and brings with it a host of features like HDMI eARC along with HDMI passthrough, support for Dolby Atmos and a wireless subwoofer. Being a simple 3.1 setup, this soundbar claims to give you an immersive surround sound experience. Does it deliver?

Build and design

A premium finish is the first thing that comes to mind when you first look at the soundbar. It has a matte finish and the front grill is not removable. It has an industrial design with slightly curved edges and a certain amount of heft to it. Even though the soundbar has chunky depth to it doesn't look intrusive when you look at it from the front.

All the ports are conveniently located at the back of the soundbar in a cavity making cable management easy. The soundbar also has a display in the front and it only comes on when the soundbar is on.

The wireless subwoofer is big and quite heavy. The subwoofer is front-firing with the pairing button hidden at the back. The soundbar also has touch controls on the top to control things like power, source, Bluetooth and volume.

Connectivity

The soundbar has an HDMI port for eARC and one HDMI passthrough port that supports 4K HDR passthrough including Dolby Vision at 4K/60P/YUV 4:4:4. It also boasts of Sony's BRAVIA SYNC which means that you can connect the soundbar wirelessly to some Sony Bravia TVs. The Sony HT-G700 also has an optical port, USB port and supports Bluetooth 5.0. There's no support for Wi-Fi and Ethernet, and there's no built-in Alexa support as well. The



BUILD	90
FEATURES	75
PERFORMANCE	73
VALUE	79

Sony HT-G700 does boast of support for DTS-X and Dolby Atmos though.

Performance

Holy smokes! This soundbar is loud. The soundbar has 400W of output and you can feel it especially when you put the volume

all the way up to 80 percent. The channel separation from left to right was superb. Even the dialogues spoken during action sequences are extremely clear. Whether watching Atmos or 5.1 content from OTT service providers, one thing is clear, the sound will immerse you just because how loud the soundbar can get and for that reason alone this is great for watching movies.

The Music performance of the Sony soundbar is what you'd expect from a Sony speaker. If you love music with good bass then this soundbar will not disappoint. If you want the extra thump, you can always increase the level of the subwoofer.

For gaming, we played Marvel Spider-Man, The Last of Us Part II, Ghost of Tsushima, God of War and Doom. Channel separation works well in all the games. For gaming, we kept the Immersive AE mode on which helped with clever dialogue and easier separation of background sound from what's happening right next to you.

By now you probably think we are in love with the sound output from this soundbar and you are right in thinking so. It checks all the right

boxes for me. There is no complication with the sound modes and there is no customisation needed. You could simply leave it on auto and forget about the rest.

So what's missing? Well, for one thing, we wish there was an app that could be used to control the soundbar.

Remote control

The bundled remote control with the soundbar is simple. All the buttons are neatly laid out in two rows.

On the remote control, you have the options for input, control for the various modes, a mute button. Buttons like 'Voice' help with boosting the vocals if you like whereas functions like Night ensure the bangs in action movies don't get too loud. You can also control the subwoofer level and there is a button to navigate the menu.

Bottomline

So here's the ever-important question. Should you spend 40K on the Sony HT-G700? Well, if you have a budget of 40K for a premium soundbar, then yes. The soundbar has fantastic sound output, supports Dolby Atmos, 4K HDR passthrough with Dolby Vision support and a simple plug and play setup. What it lacks is any form of internet connectivity or app controls. With Immersive AE turned on, you get clearer audio especially the separation between the dialogues and background score. The Sony HT-G700 is also a 400W soundbar that can get plenty loud when compared to other soundbars in the market.

—Sameer Mitha

SPECIFICATIONS

AMPLIFIER TYPE: Digital Amplifier, S-Master | SPEAKER STRUCTURE: 3.1 ch (wireless Subwoofer) | POWER OUTPUT: 400 W | SUBWOOFER TYPE: Wireless | WEIGHT: Main unit (body only) - 3.5 kg, Subwoofer weight - 7.5 kg | INPUT AND OUTPUT TERMINALS: Optical audio input, USB Type-A, FAT32 | BLUETOOTH: v5.0 | BLUETOOTH CODECS: SBC, AAC | SOUND MODES: Auto Sound, Cinema, Music, Standard | VIRTUAL SURROUND TECHNOLOGY: S-Force PRO, Vertical Surround Engine, DTS Virtual:X | POWER CONSUMPTION: BAR 45 W/SW 20 W

CONTACT

SONY INDIA | PHONE: 1800 103 7799 | EMAIL: Web form | WEBSITE: <http://www.sony.co.in/>